

THE GUEST JOURNEY

EIGHT STAGES. ONE EXPERIENCE. ZERO TOLERANCE FOR FAILURE.

THE GUEST DOESN'T SEE STAGES — THEY SEE ONE UNBROKEN EXPERIENCE. EVERY GAP SHOWS.

1 DISCOVERY

The guest's experience begins the moment they consider attending — before a ticket is purchased. Social media, word of mouth, and digital ads shape the expectation. A confusing or uninspiring discovery experience kills intent before the journey starts. **The impression at this stage sets the standard for everything that follows.**

2 TICKET PURCHASE

Checkout friction is the single largest driver of abandoned ticket purchases. A slow platform, unclear seating map, or unexpected fee at the final screen loses the sale entirely — and often the guest. **The purchase experience is the first operational test of what the venue promises to deliver.**

3 PARKING & TRANSIT

Guests arrive at the high of anticipation. A chaotic parking experience is the fastest way to replace that feeling with frustration before they've set foot inside. Clear pre-event communication, digital parking passes, and real-time traffic guidance are now baseline expectations — not differentiators.

4 ENTRY

Gate entry is the first physical promise the venue makes. A 15-minute scan queue at capacity is not a minor inconvenience — it is a systemic failure broadcast to every person in line simultaneously. Mobile ticketing, express lanes, and staff-to-guest ratios at peak entry are the controllable variables that separate good entry from damaging ones.

5 FOOD & BEVERAGE

F&B is the largest controllable revenue category inside any live event. It is also the most friction-prone. A guest who misses part of the action waiting in line doesn't just lose the purchase window — they lose the moment. Mobile ordering, in-seat delivery, and self-checkout stations directly convert wait-time frustration into captured revenue.

6 SEAT / STANDING AREA

This is the product the guest paid for. Sightlines, comfort, proximity, and the energy of the crowd around them are the peak of the experience arc. Everything the operator does before and after this moment reflects in the bottom line and guest sentiment of the experience.

7 EXIT

The exit is the last thing the guest experiences — and therefore the last thing they remember. A 45-minute parking lot crawl after a great game doesn't just create a frustrating ending. It becomes the dominant memory. Staggered release strategies, post-event parking communication, and transit partnerships exist for this reason.

8 POST-EVENT FOLLOW-UP

The experience doesn't end at the parking lot. A timely post-event email, a personalized offer for the next game, or a push notification with a highlight recap can convert a satisfied attendee into a season ticket holder. **The guest's emotional window stays open for 24–48 hours after a great event. What happens in that window is revenue the venue either captures or leaves on the table.**